

In the news

Drug approvals in 2025 in gastroenterology and hepatology

In 2025, the [FDA's Centre for Drug Evaluation and Research \(CDER\)](#) approved 46 novel therapeutic agents. Of those, two were related to metabolic disorders: Lerochol (LIB Therapeutics; lerodalcibep-liga, a PCSK9 blocker) was approved as an adjunct to diet and exercise to reduce low-density lipoprotein cholesterol in adults with hypercholesterolaemia, including heterozygous familial hypercholesterolaemia. Redemplo (Arrowhead Pharmaceuticals; plozasiran, a small interfering RNA that silences the *APOC3* gene) was approved as an adjunct to diet to reduce triglycerides in adults with familial chylomicronaemia syndrome. In [2024](#), the FDA novel approvals were 50, of which 5 were related to gastroenterology and hepatology.

Among the [notable drug approvals](#), six pertained to gastroenterology, hepatology and obesity. For example, Linzess (Abbvie; linaclotide, a guanylate cyclase C agonist), as first treatment for paediatric functional constipation, and the first drug approved for children 7 years and older with irritable bowel syndrome with constipation; Rinvoq (Abbvie; upadacitinib, a Janus kinase inhibitor), as first oral treatment for moderately to severely active Crohn's disease in adults with an inadequate response or intolerance to tumour necrosis factor blockers; and Wegovy (Novo Nordisk; semaglutide) is the first glucagon-like peptide 1 (GLP1) receptor agonist approved for the treatment of metabolic dysfunction-associated steatohepatitis in adults with moderate-to-advanced liver fibrosis.

Other FDA approvals include Opdivo (Bristol-Myers Squibb; nivolumab, a programmed cell death protein 1-blocking antibody) in combination with ipilimumab

(a human cytotoxic T lymphocyte protein 4-blocking antibody) for the first-line treatment of adult patients with unresectable or metastatic hepatocellular carcinoma, and Imfinzi (AstraZeneca; durvalumab, a programmed cell death 1 ligand 1-blocking antibody) with chemotherapy as neoadjuvant and adjuvant treatment for adults with resectable gastric or gastro-oesophageal junction adenocarcinoma.

Wegovy was also approved for weight management in adults with obesity or overweight. For weight management in patients 12 years and older, the FDA approved Saxenda (Novo Nordisk; liraglutide), a GLP1 receptor agonist, and Qsymia (VIVUS; phentermine and topiramate, an appetite suppressant and a medication that enhances satiety).

In [paediatric oncology](#), the FDA approved nine drugs, among which were Opdivo as a single agent or in combination with ipilimumab and Yervoy (Bristol-Myers Squibb; ipilimumab) for the treatment of patients 12 years and older with microsatellite instability-high or mismatch repair-deficient metastatic colorectal cancer. Cabometyx (Exelixis; cabozantinib, a tyrosine kinase inhibitor) was approved for the treatment of patients 12 years and older with previously treated, unresectable, locally advanced or metastatic, well-differentiated extra-pancreatic or pancreatic neuroendocrine tumours.

Among the [biosimilar products](#) that were approved by the FDA in 2025 were Starjemza (Bio-Thera Solutions), a biosimilar to Stelara (Janssen; ustekinumab, a monoclonal antibody targeting IL-12 and IL-23) for the treatment of moderately to severely active Crohn's disease and ulcerative colitis, and

Jobevne (Biocon Biologics), a biosimilar to Avastin (Genentech; bevacizumab, a monoclonal antibody to vascular endothelial growth factor) for the treatment of various solid tumours, including colorectal cancer.

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Finally, the [European Medicines Agency](#) and the European Commission authorized several drugs in 2025, including Aybintio (Samsung Bioepis; bevacizumab), a biosimilar to Avastin, and Avastin in combination with fluoropyrimidine-based chemotherapy for the treatment of adult patients with metastatic colon or rectum carcinoma; Tremfya (Janssen; guselkumab, a monoclonal antibody targeting the p19 subunit of IL-23) for the treatment of adult patients with moderately to severely active ulcerative colitis or Crohn's disease; Ziihera (Zymeworks; zanidatamab, a bispecific antibody targeting HER2) for the treatment of unresectable locally advanced or metastatic HER2⁺ biliary tract cancer in adults; and Mounjaro (Eli Lilly; tirzepatide, a dual agonist for the glucose-dependent insulinotropic polypeptide and GLP1) for the treatment of adults with insufficiently controlled type 2 diabetes and for weight management in adults with obesity or overweight in the presence of at least one weight-related comorbid condition (for example, cardiovascular disease) as an adjunct to a reduced-calorie diet and increased physical activity.

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